

# Cybersecurity Daily Newsletter

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## Top 5 Highlights

- 21st September - Threat Intelligence Report
- AI intelligence report falsely identifies weapons on Chinese ship, nearly triggers US military operation
- Google had undercover analyst inside TeamPCP hacking group
- CISA adds Linux kernel flaws to exploited vulnerabilities catalog
- Trump calls for AI Force, says AI Czar will be named soon

# Threat Intelligence (10)

## 01. Transparent Tribe targets India, Afghanistan with new malware in Operation RapidRust

A Pakistan-aligned threat group, known as Transparent Tribe or APT36, has been linked to a new wave of cyberattacks targeting government and defense organizations in India and Afghanistan, according to Zscaler ThreatLabz.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/transparent-tribe-targets-india-afghanistan-with-new-malware-in-operation-rapidrust>

## 02. New Rapuncel infostealer campaign uses fake GitHub repos to disable antivirus

The campaign, uncovered by LastPass and Delphos Labs, impersonates LastPass and at least 39 other companies.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/new-rapuncel-infostealer-campaign-uses-fake-github-repos-to-disable-antivirus>

## 03. Meta Muse AI app flaw lets local malware redirect dictation traffic

Ad biz promises users control while bug could expose voice prompts

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.theregister.com/ai-and-ml/2026/09/21/meta-muse-ai-app-flaw-lets-local-malware-redirect-dictation-traffic/5297980>

## 04. Cybercriminals Are Hiding New Malware in Torrents for Popular Films

Victims have been identified in Africa, including in Kenya and Uganda.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.darkreading.com/cyberattacks-data-breaches/cybercriminals-hiding-new-malware-torrents-popular-films>

## 05. Fake LastPass Installers Push Kernel-Level EDR Killer, 'Rapuncel' Stealer

The attackers impersonate at least 40 companies and disable 145 security products to deploy infostealer malware. The post Fake LastPass Installers Push Kernel-Level EDR Killer, 'Rapuncel' Stealer appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources:

<https://www.securityweek.com/fake-lastpass-installers-push-kernel-level-edr-killer-rapuncel-stealer/>

## 06. New npm malware finds a way around install script defenses

Blocking suspicious install scripts may no longer be enough to mitigate threats from malicious JavaScript dependencies used in software supply-chain attacks. Security researchers at Checkmarx are warning of attackers using a malicious package called "indexed-btree" to impersonate the legitimate sorted-btree library, to spread malware hidden in the package's...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.csoononline.com/article/4224400/new-npm-malware-finds-a-way-around-install-script-defenses-2.html>

## 07. TASK#STOMP PowerShell Backdoor Steals Documents, Wi-Fi Passwords, and Clipboard Data

Cybersecurity researchers have disclosed details of a new campaign dubbed TASK#STOMP that delivers a PowerShell backdoor designed to harvest sensitive data from compromised hosts. The backdoor "automatically harvests and exfiltrates business documents, watches the filesystem for new files in real time, steals Wi-Fi passwords and clipboard contents, takes sc...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/09/taskstomp-powershell-backdoor-steals.html>

## 08. The TASK#STOMP Windows backdoor takes Wi-Fi passwords, screenshots, and business files

Researchers have taken apart TASK#STOMP, a Windows backdoor that searches a victim's drives for business documents, uploads them to attacker servers, and then stays put to grab each new or edited document. The same malware steals saved Wi-Fi passwords and clipboard text, takes screenshots, and runs whatever command its operators send. Akshay Gaikwad and Aar...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/09/21/taskstomp-windows-backdoor/>

## 09. Attackers Abuse npm Trusted Publishing in GHAPPIER Campaign

CloudSEK linked GHAPPIER to a compromised npm package with valid trusted-publishing provenance

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/attackers-abuse-npm-trusted/>

## 10. Microsoft reminds admins to migrate Entra ID users to passkeys

Microsoft has reminded admins to migrate Entra ID users to phishing-resistant authentication methods to avoid sign-in disruptions after it retires SMS first-factor sign-in starting in February 2027. [...]

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/microsoft/microsoft-reminds-admins-to-migrate-entra-id-users-to-passkeys/>

# Latest Vulnerabilities (10)

## 01. 21st September - Threat Intelligence Report

For the latest discoveries in cyber research for the week of 21st September, please download our Threat Intelligence Bulletin. TOP ATTACKS AND BREACHES Japan's Digital Agency, which operates the Government Solution Service used by multiple ministries, has confirmed a data breach after attackers exploited a vulnerability in a VPN appliance. Approximately 246...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://research.checkpoint.com/2026/21st-september-threat-intelligence-report/>

## 02. AI intelligence report falsely identifies weapons on Chinese ship, nearly triggers US military operation

An analyst at Special Operations Command Pacific used a chatbot to analyze intelligence regarding a Chinese ship, combining open-source and classified signals intelligence, as first reported by CNN.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/ai-intelligence-report-falsely-identifies-weapons-on-chinese-ship-nearly-triggers-us-military-operation>

### 03. Google had undercover analyst inside TeamPCP hacking group

TeamPCP, known for its widespread malware distribution through open-source software and developer account hijacking, compromised hundreds of programs and breached over a thousand companies.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/google-had-undercover-analyst-inside-teampcp-hacking-group>

### 04. CISA adds Linux kernel flaws to exploited vulnerabilities catalog

CISA has ordered federal agencies to remediate these issues by September 21, 2026, as per Binding Operational Directive 22-01.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/cisa-adds-linux-kernel-flaws-to-exploited-vulnerabilities-catalog>

### 05. Trump calls for AI Force, says AI Czar will be named soon

Trump's planned AI Force renews debate over guardrails and accountability for AI.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/news/trump-calls-for-ai-force-says-ai-czar-will-be-named-soon>

### 06. Army and Air Force Exchange Service investigating suspicious customer messages

The suspicious messages, which included a "wishlist" link and potentially other circulating communications, were also distributed through AAFES's official app.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/army-and-air-force-exchange-service-investigating-suspicious-customer-messages>

## 07. Anthropic-linked CVEs pile up, attackers mostly shrug

Of 225 flaws found by Glasswing and tracked by VulnCheck researcher, just one has confirmed exploitation in the wild

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.theregister.com/security/2026/09/21/anthropic-linked-cves-pile-up-attackers-mostly-shrug/5298018>

## 08. BigCommerce alerts merchants of data breach linked to Ribon apps

Ecommerce platform BigCommerce has alerted multiple merchants to data breaches after attackers compromised credentials for third-party Ribon applications and used them to inject malicious scripts into online stores. [...]

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/bigcommerce-alerts-merchants-of-data-breach-linked-to-ribon-apps/>

## 09. CISA alerts of active exploitation of three Linux kernel flaws

The U.S. Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA) is warning that hackers are exploiting three Linux kernel vulnerabilities, one of them rated critical. [...]

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/cisa-alerts-of-active-exploitation-of-three-linux-kernel-flaws/>

## 10. WordPress Click2Shell flaw lets hackers execute PHP on the server

Technical details and a proof-of-concept exploit have been published for a new WordPress cross-site request forgery (CSRF) vulnerability dubbed 'Click2Shell' that affects the platform's Core component. [...]

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/wordpress-click2shell-flaw-lets-hackers-execute-php-on-the-server/>

## Data Breach & Cybercrime (10)

### 01. ShinyHunters defaces Clop ransomware data leak site, claims data theft

ShinyHunters claims to have exploited an unauthenticated file upload vulnerability in Grav CMS to deface the Clop Tor site with ASCII art of its Umbreon logo.

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources:

<https://www.scworld.com/brief/shinyhunters-defaces-clop-ransomware-data-leak-site-claims-data-theft>

### 02. Texas man pleads guilty in Scattered Spider extortion scheme

Based on information from CyberScoop, a 24-year-old Texas man, Ahmed Hossam Eldin Elbadawy, has pleaded guilty to federal charges related to his involvement in the Scattered Spider cybercrime group's extortion activities.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/texas-man-pleads-guilty-in-scattered-spider-extortion-scheme>

### 03. ShinyHunters Hacked Clop. Now What About Clop's Victims?

ShinyHunters defaced Clop's Dark Web site and claims to have stolen victim data, potentially exposing organizations that paid ransoms to renewed extortion attempts.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.darkreading.com/cyberattacks-data-breaches/shinyhunters-hacked-clop-what-about-t-clops-victims>

### 04. Google Hit With \$463 Million Fine for EU Location Data Rule Breach

Google has been fined 403 million euros (\$463 million) for breaching the European Union's strict privacy rules because it mishandled users' location data. The post Google Hit With \$463 Million Fine for EU Location Data Rule Breach appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources:

<https://www.securityweek.com/google-hit-with-463-million-fine-for-eu-location-data-rule-breach/>

## 05. Gemini's breach of real companies exposes an AI guardrail problem

Gemini crossed the boundaries of a capture-the-flag test and accessed systems belonging to three real companies.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.malwarebytes.com/blog/ai/2026/09/geminis-breach-of-real-companies-exposes-an-ai-guardrail-problem>

## 06. Clop gets a taste of its own medicine after ShinyHunters hijack leak site

Rival crew demands eight figures and threatens to expose companies that paid to keep quiet

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.theregister.com/cyber-crime/2026/09/21/clop-gets-a-taste-of-its-own-medicine-after-shinyhunters-hijack-leak-site/5297702>

## 07. ShinyHunters Claim Hack of Rival Ransomware Gang Clop

ShinyHunters has claimed responsibility for hacking the Clop ransomware group, defacing its leak site and alleging theft of key operational data

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/shinyhunters-claim-hack-of-clop/>

## 08. North Korea's job interview scam runs both ways

Attackers are targeting members of the Rust Project and maintainers of widely used crates (Rust code libraries), dangling attractive opportunities to compromise their devices and accounts and, ultimately, publish malware. The warning came last week from the Rust Project's crates.io team and security response working group, and described a recurring pattern:...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources:

<https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/09/21/north-korean-hackers-contagious-interview-defenses/>

## 09. CrowdSec Confirms Source Code Stolen in Supply Chain Attack

The cybersecurity firm believes the data breach was the result of the May 2026 TanStack supply chain attack. The post CrowdSec Confirms Source Code Stolen in Supply Chain Attack appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.securityweek.com/crowdsec-confirms-source-code-stolen-in-supply-chain-attack/>

## 10. Scammers impersonate cops, use arrest threats to extort victims

Scammers are posing as police officers and federal agents, threatening arrest unless victims pay up, the FBI warns. The FBI's Internet Crime Complaint Center (IC3) updated an alert it first issued in 2022, citing "losses totaling more than \$1.6 billion" between January 2025 and July 2026. According to the FBI, most complaints involve a caller who accuses th...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/09/21/fake-police-federal-agents-scams/>